Flow 1: Admin only

Goal: Run the internal business application with no public website.

You get: a secured admin app: users, roles, company identity, themes, notifications, files and an activity log.

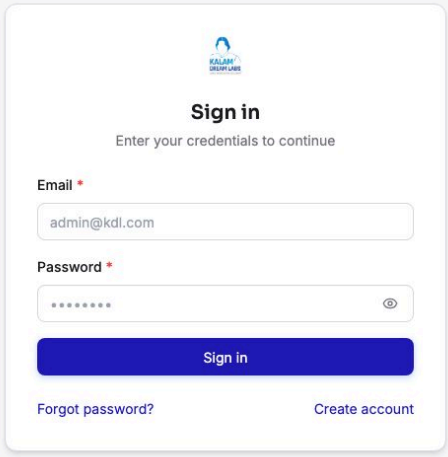
Products to tick: Admin only (leave Website and Landing Pages off). In the wizard, Step 2, press **Next** with no cards ticked; it records "no website" and stops asking.

Sign in › Setup wizard › Enable modules › Build › Publish

Sign in

> KDL OS must already be installed and running. If not, follow the **Installation** guide first (Admin > Documents > Installation).

Open **http://localhost/login**. Email `admin@kdl.com`, password `kdl-dev-seed-password`. KDL OS asks you to choose a new password on first sign-in.



The sign-in screen

> Forgot the password or locked out? `docker compose exec backend node scripts/reset-admin-password.js --email admin@kdl.com --password 'Admin@123'` (at least 8 characters), then sign in with it. 429 or "Account locked" while testing: wait a minute or `docker compose restart backend`.

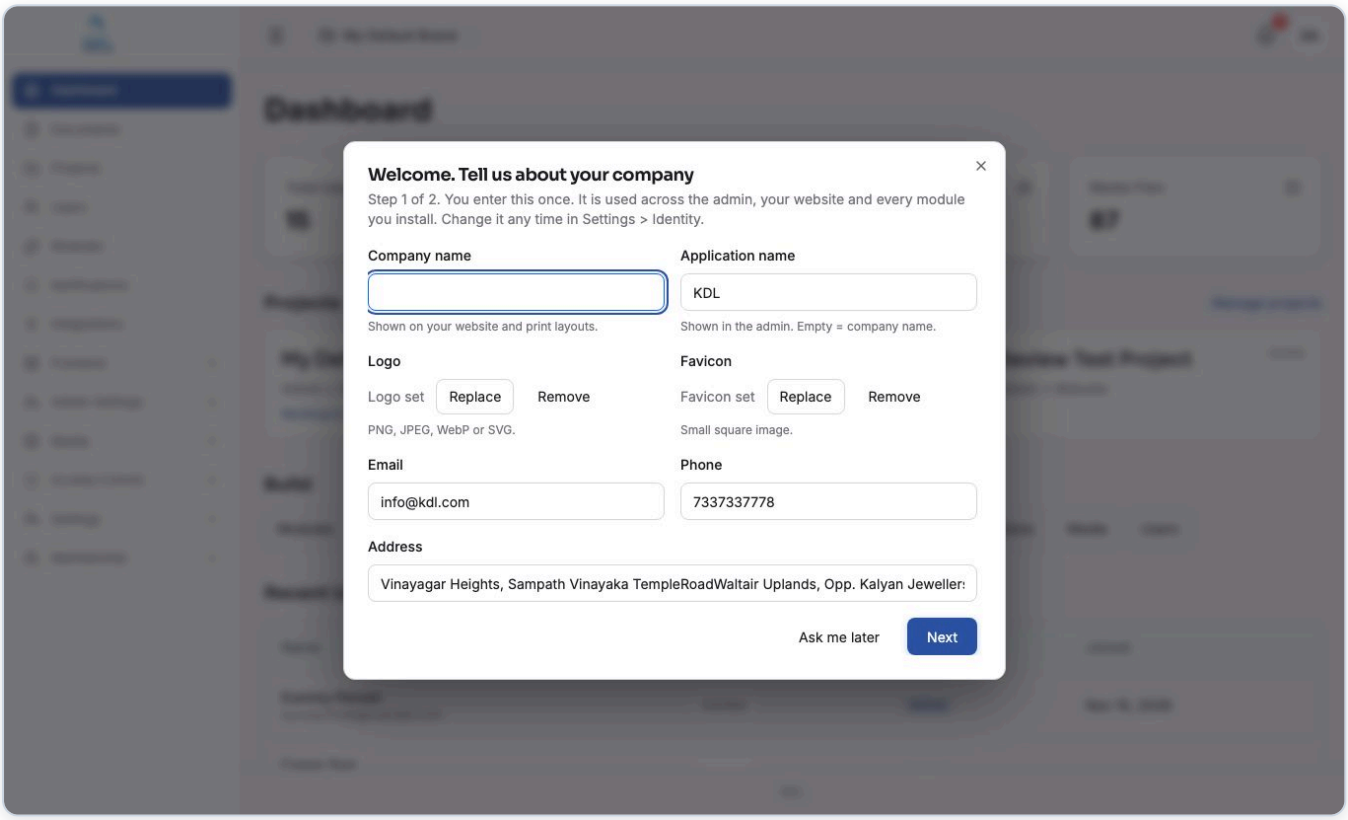
> Screenshots are from a running KDL OS install where these modules are already enabled, so cards show **Enabled** and **Disable**. On a fresh install the same cards show **Available** with an **Install** button (see the card mockup in Part C).

Part B. First-run setup wizard

On a fresh install a **Setup wizard** opens over the admin. It asks three things, in this order.

B1. Step 1 of 2: your company

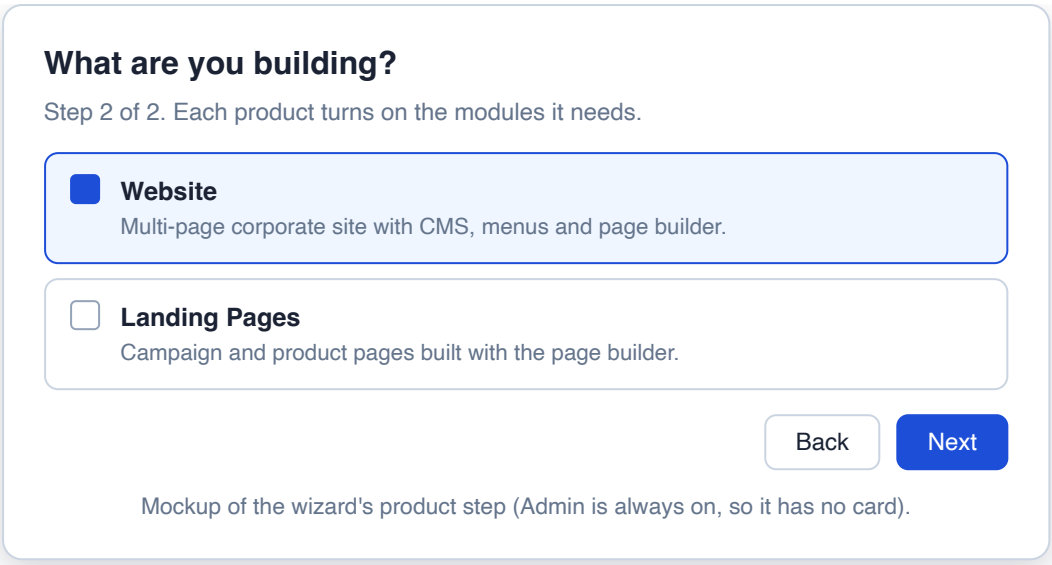
Company name, application name, logo, favicon, email, phone and address. You enter this once; it is used by the admin, the website and every module. Change it any time in **Admin Settings > Identity**. **Ask me later** closes the wizard without saving.



Setup wizard, step 1 (real screen)

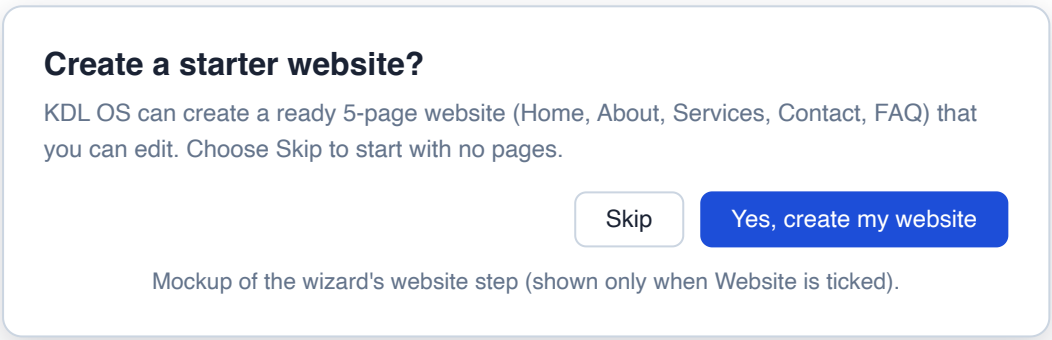
B2. Step 2 of 2: what are you building?

Tick the products you need. **Admin is always on** and has no card. Each product turns on the modules it needs, and the wizard shows what changes before you press **Next**.



Mockup of the wizard's product step (Admin is always on, so it has no card).

B3. Only if Website is ticked: starter website



Mockup of the wizard's website step (shown only when Website is ticked).

Yes, create my website builds a ready 5-page site (Home, About, Services, Contact, FAQ) you can edit. **Skip** starts with no pages.

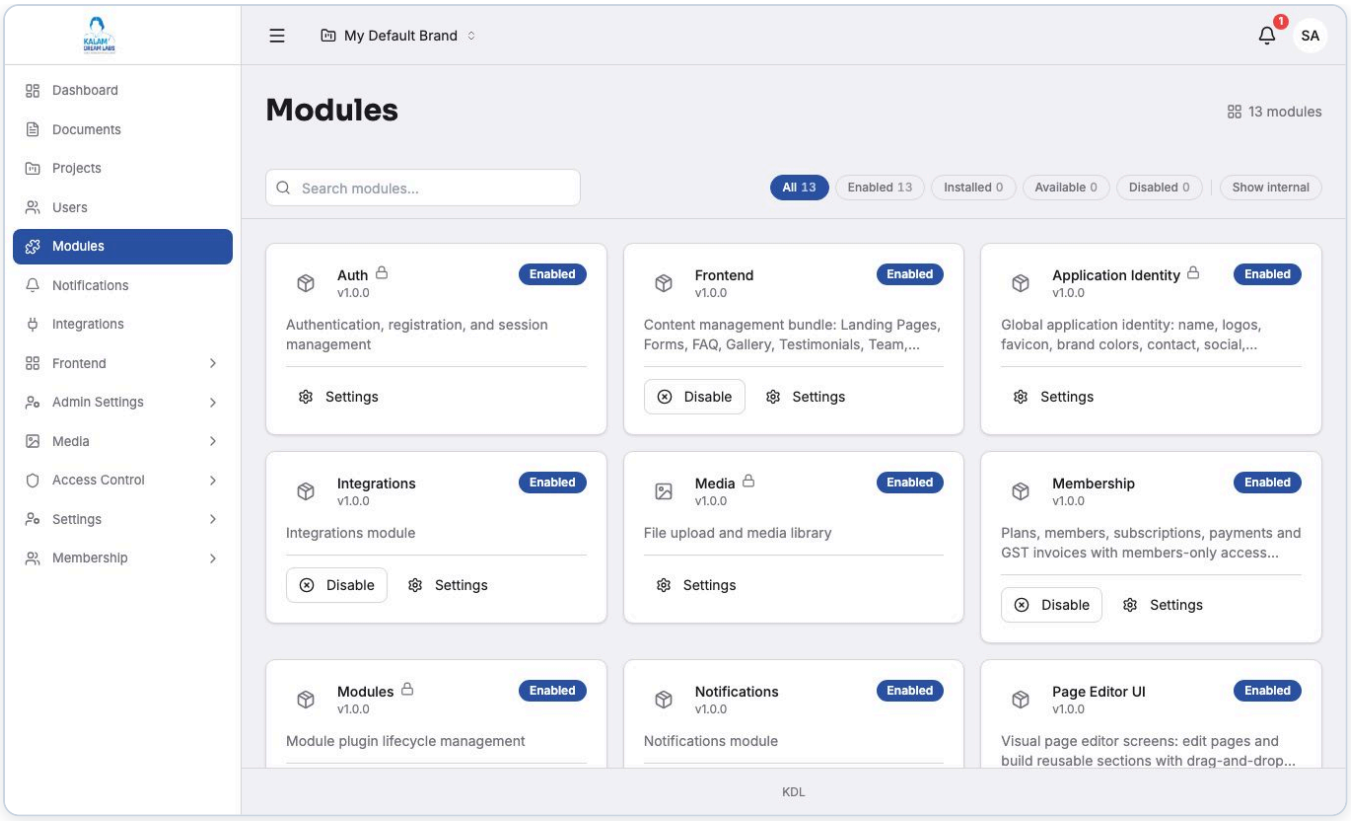
> Missed or dismissed the wizard? Company details live in **Admin Settings > Identity**; products live at **/admin/settings/products**. Nothing is deleted when you turn a product off.

Part C. Install and enable the modules

After you sign in (and answer or close the wizard), open **Modules** in the left sidebar. This is where every capability is switched on. A module has to be **installed** once and then **enabled**; a module that is off has no menu entry and its routes return 404. Data is never deleted by turning a module off.

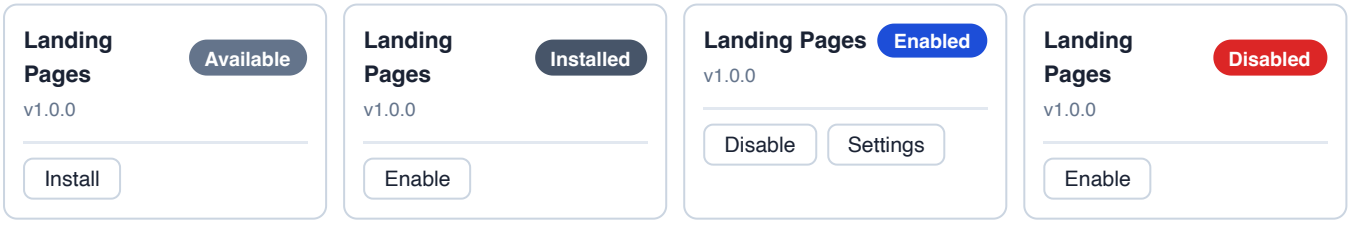
C1. What the Modules screen shows

At the top: a **search box**, the filter chips **All, Enabled, Installed, Available, Disabled**, and **Show internal**. Below: one card per module with its status badge and buttons. A padlock beside the name means a **core** module that is always on (Auth, Application Identity, Media, Modules, Settings, User Management, Users).



Modules: 13 cards in the default view, status badges and Disable / Settings buttons

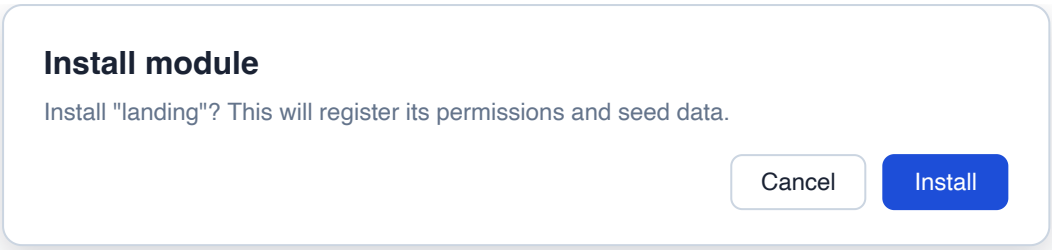
Badge	Button on the card	What pressing it does
Available (not installed yet)	**Install**	Registers the module's permissions and seeds its data. It becomes **Installed**.
Installed	**Enable**	Routes and menu items go live immediately. It becomes **Enabled**.
Enabled	**Disable**	Routes return 404 and menu entries disappear. Data is kept. **Settings** edits the module's JSON settings.
Disabled	**Enable**	Switches it back on with its data intact.



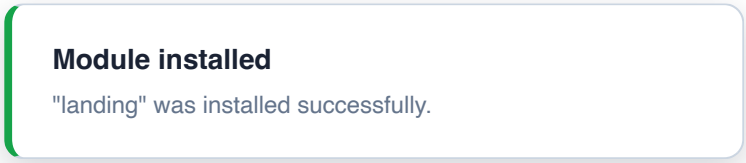
Mockup: the four states of one module card and the button each one shows.

C2. Install, then enable: the two clicks

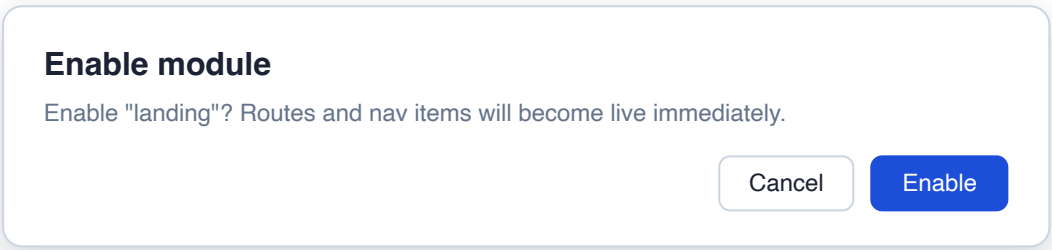
1. Press **Install** on the card. A confirmation asks you to confirm.



2. A green message says the module was installed, and the card now shows **Enable**.



3. Press **Enable** and confirm. Menu items for the module appear in the sidebar straight away (refresh the page if they do not).

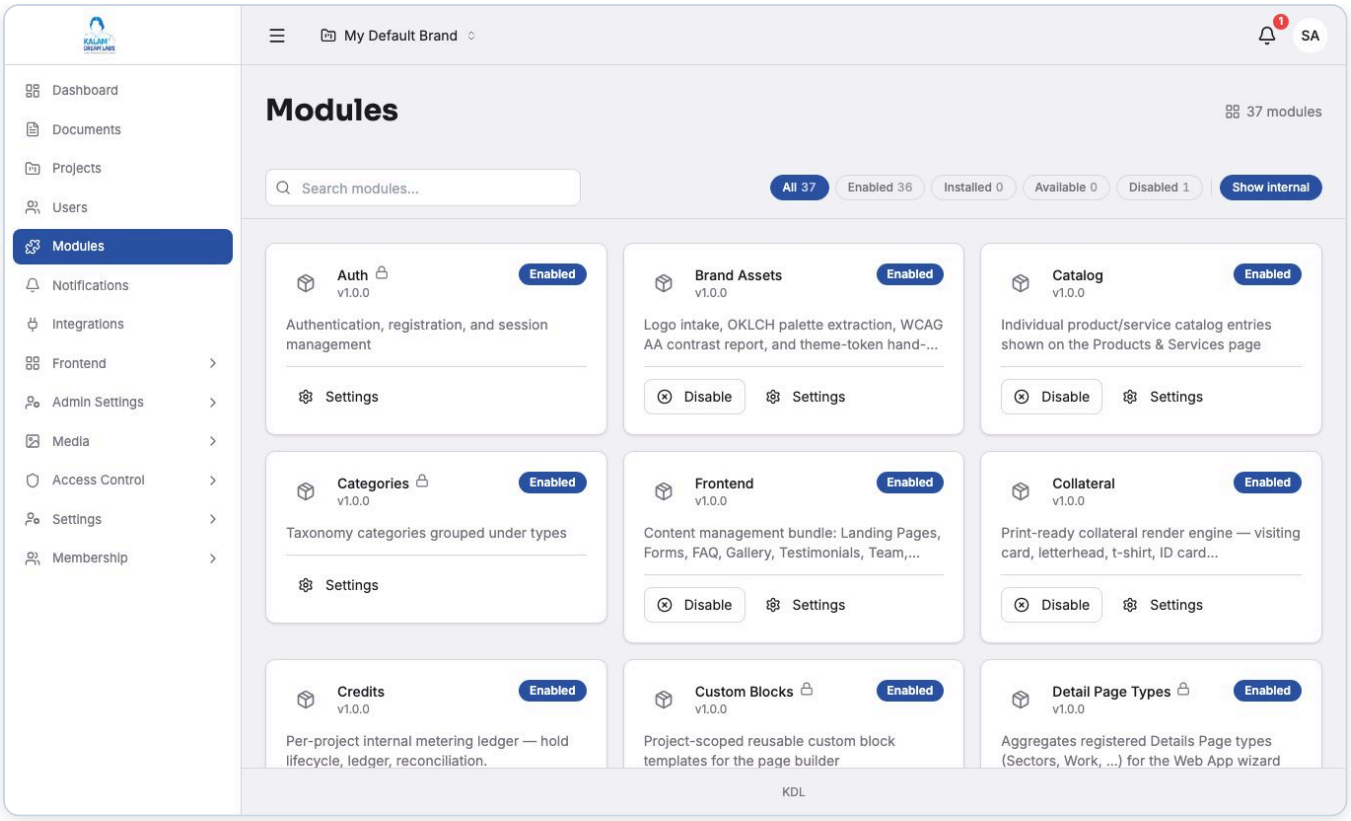


> **Dependencies are handled for you.** Installing or enabling a module also installs and enables everything it needs, in the right order. A module cannot be disabled while another enabled module still needs it; disable that one first.

> **Conflicts:** if two modules cannot run together, KDL OS shows a **Switch** dialog listing the modules that will be disabled. It is non-destructive; press **Enable & switch** to continue or **Cancel**.

C3. Default view versus "Show internal"

The default view shows 13 top-level cards. **Frontend** is a **bundle**: it stands for Website, Landing Pages, Forms, FAQ, Gallery, Testimonials, Team, Catalog, Work, Sectors and Projects Content together. Press **Show internal** to list every individual module (37), such as **Landing Pages**, **Website** and **Templates** (the Studio).



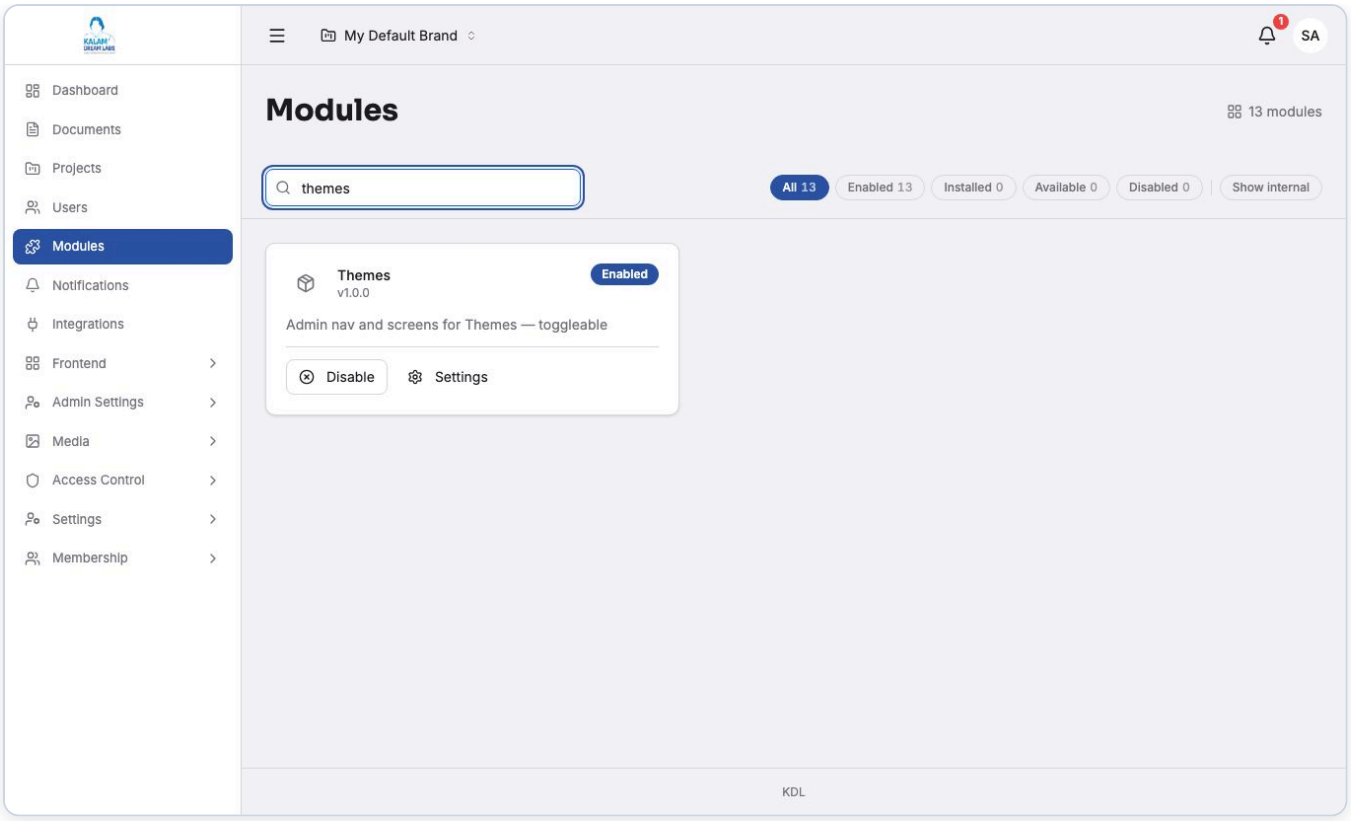
Show internal: every individual module appears (37)

Modules this flow needs

	Modules
Must be on	Auth, Application Identity, Settings, Users, User Management (Roles / Permissions), Media, Modules (all core, already on)
Optional	Themes (to restyle the admin), Notifications, Integrations, Membership
Can stay off	Frontend, Landing Pages, Templates, Page Editor UI

C4. Do this for the Admin only flow

1. Check the padlocked core cards are **Enabled**: Auth, Application Identity, Media, Modules, Settings, User Management, Users. Nothing to install.
2. Optional: **Themes** (to restyle the admin), **Notifications**, **Integrations**, **Membership**. For each one found by search: **Install**, confirm, **Enable**, confirm.

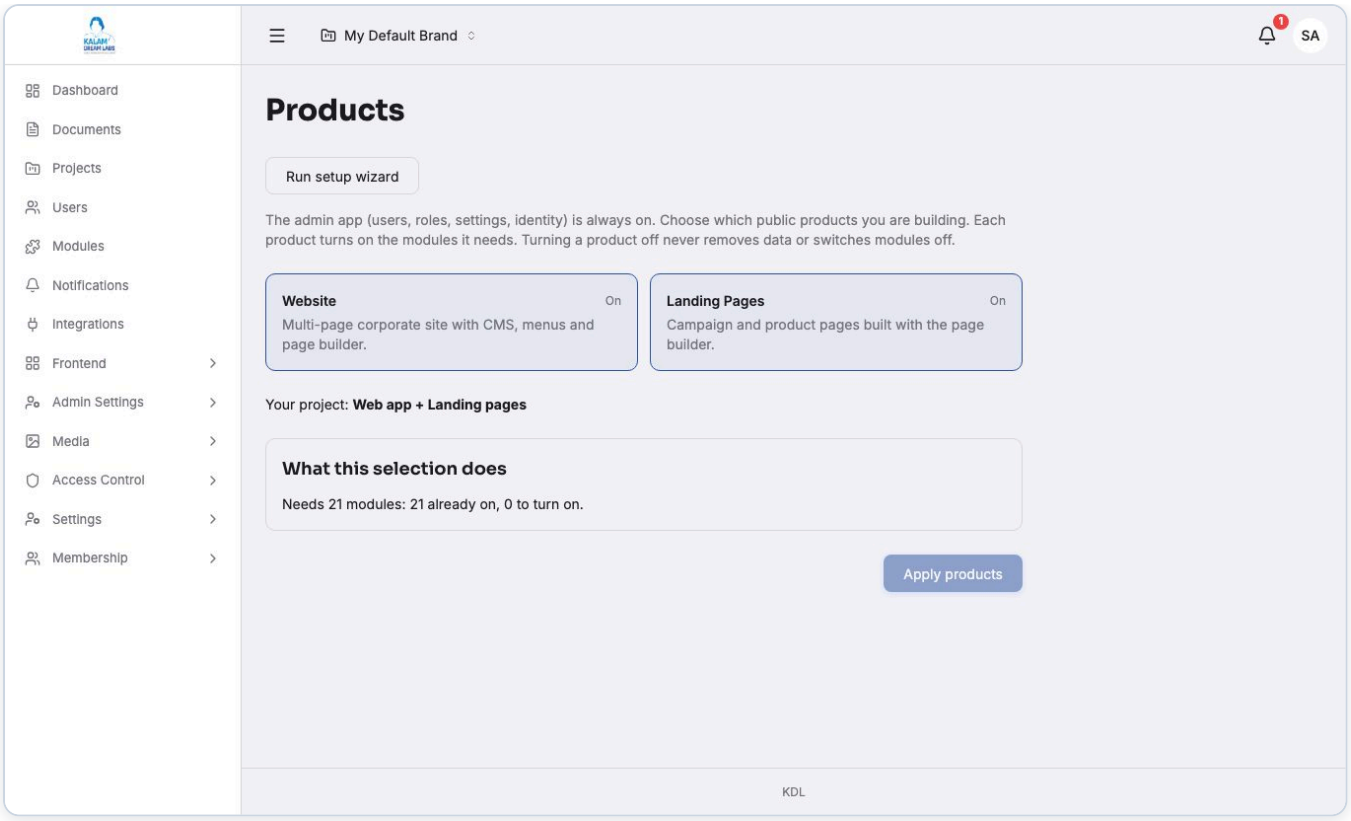


Search "themes", then Install and Enable

3. Leave the public-site modules off. If **Frontend** shows **Enabled** and you do not want website menus, press **Disable** and confirm. Pages and data stay.

C5. The shortcut: let KDL OS do it from the products you tick

The Setup wizard (Part B) and **Admin Settings > Products** (**/admin/settings/products**) enable every module the products need, in dependency order, and show **What this selection does** before you press **Apply products**. Use the Modules screen when you want one module at a time or need to switch something off.

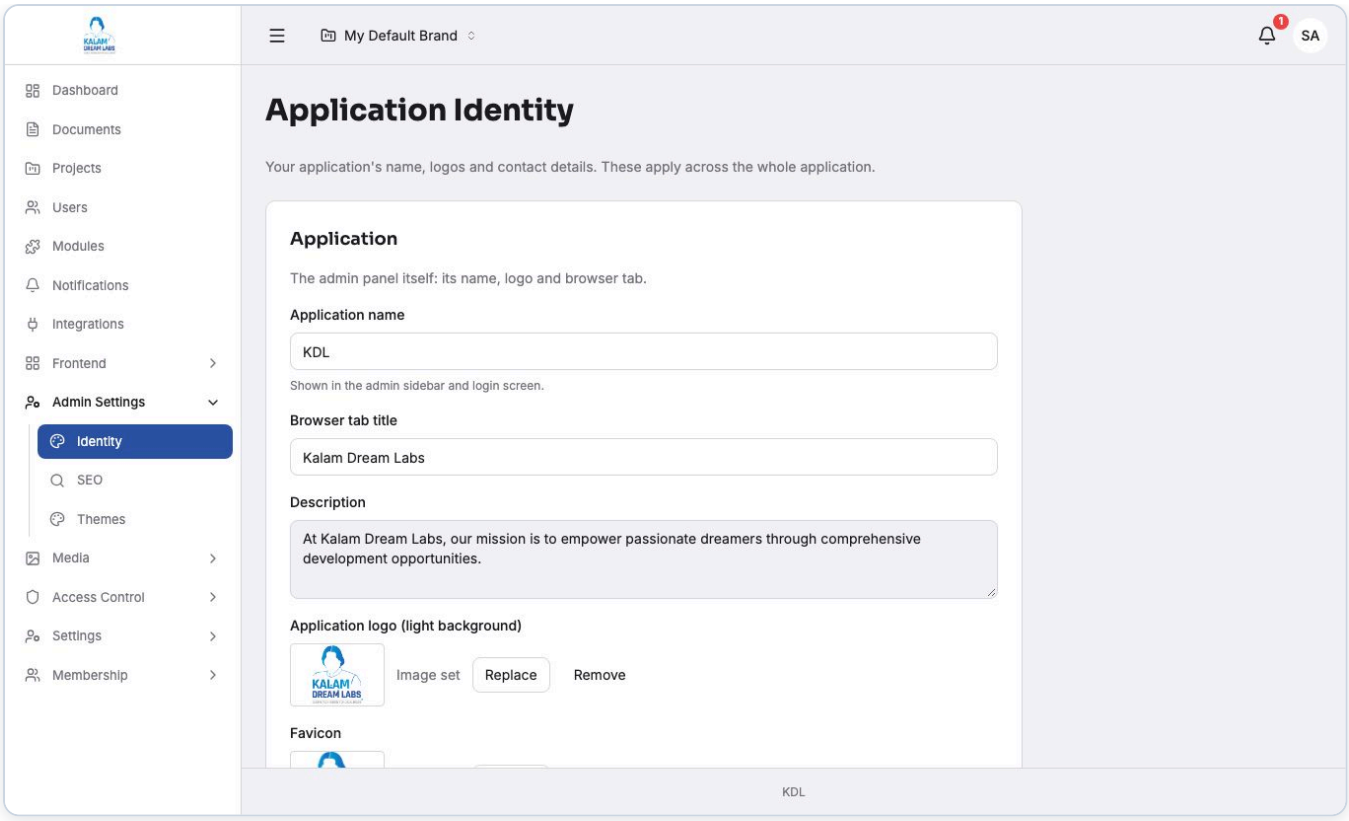


Admin Settings > Products

Part D. Build it

Set the company details once

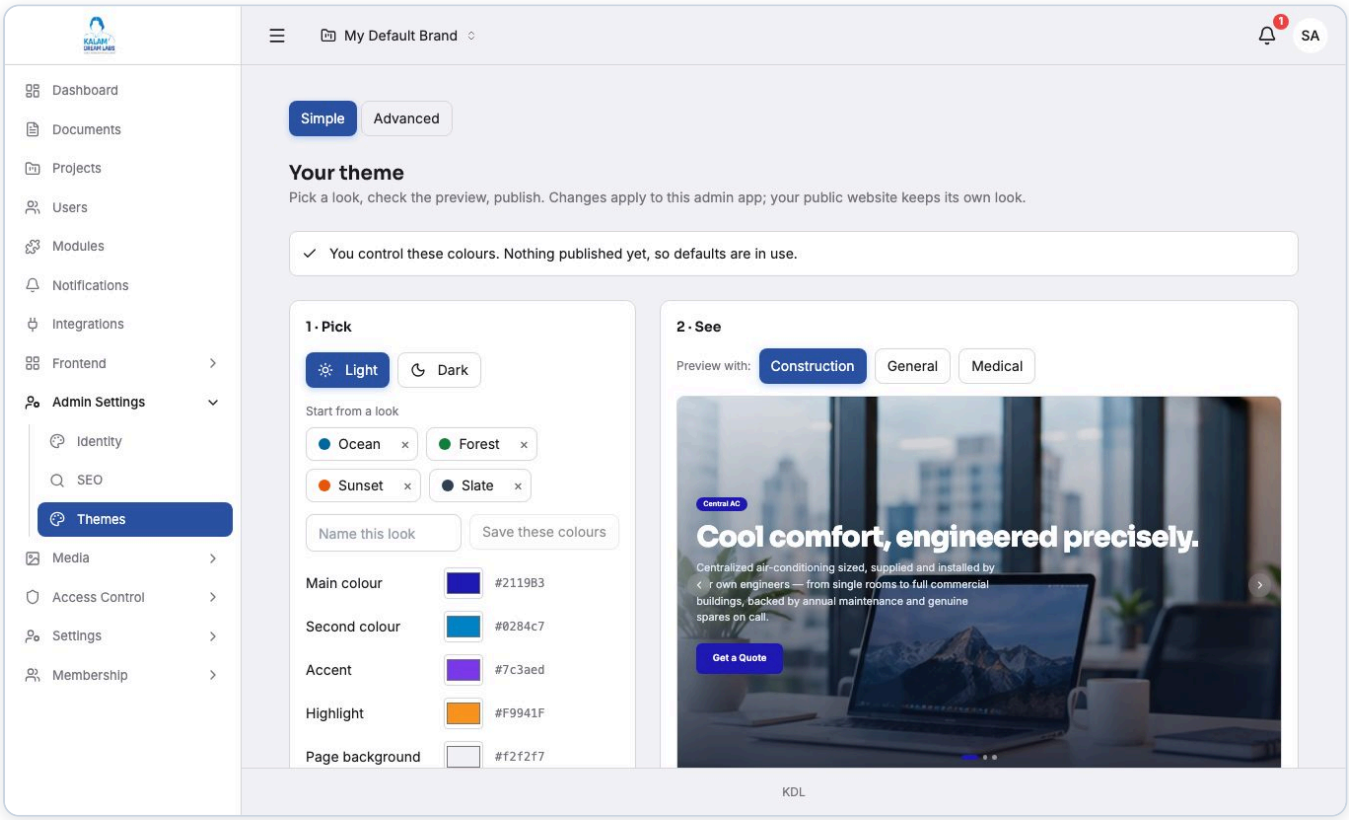
Admin Settings > Identity. Name, logos, favicon, brand colours, contact details, social links. Everything else reads from here.



Admin Settings > Identity

Pick the look

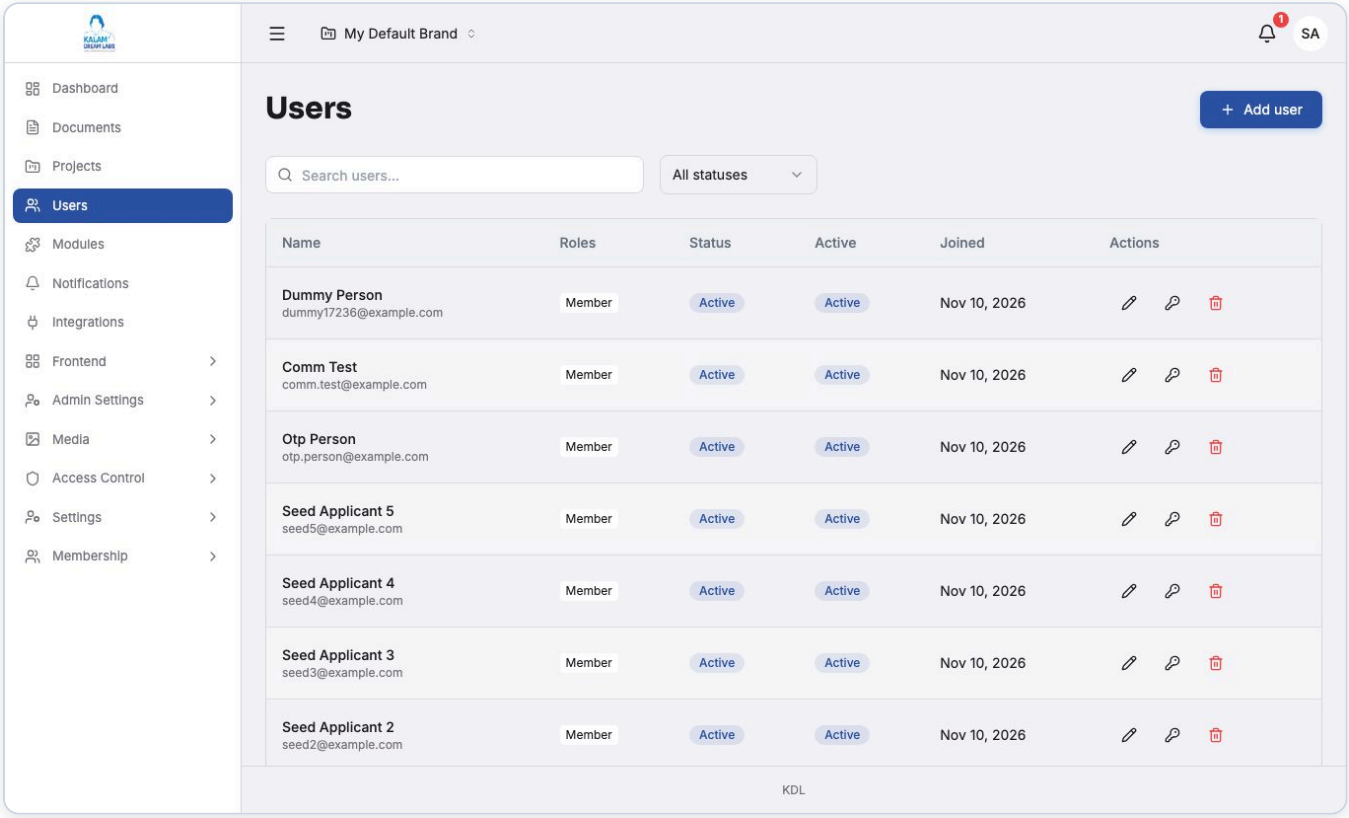
Admin Settings > Themes. Choose **Website** (public site) or **Admin app** (this panel) at the top, **Simple** for colours and fonts or **Advanced** for every token, then **Publish**.



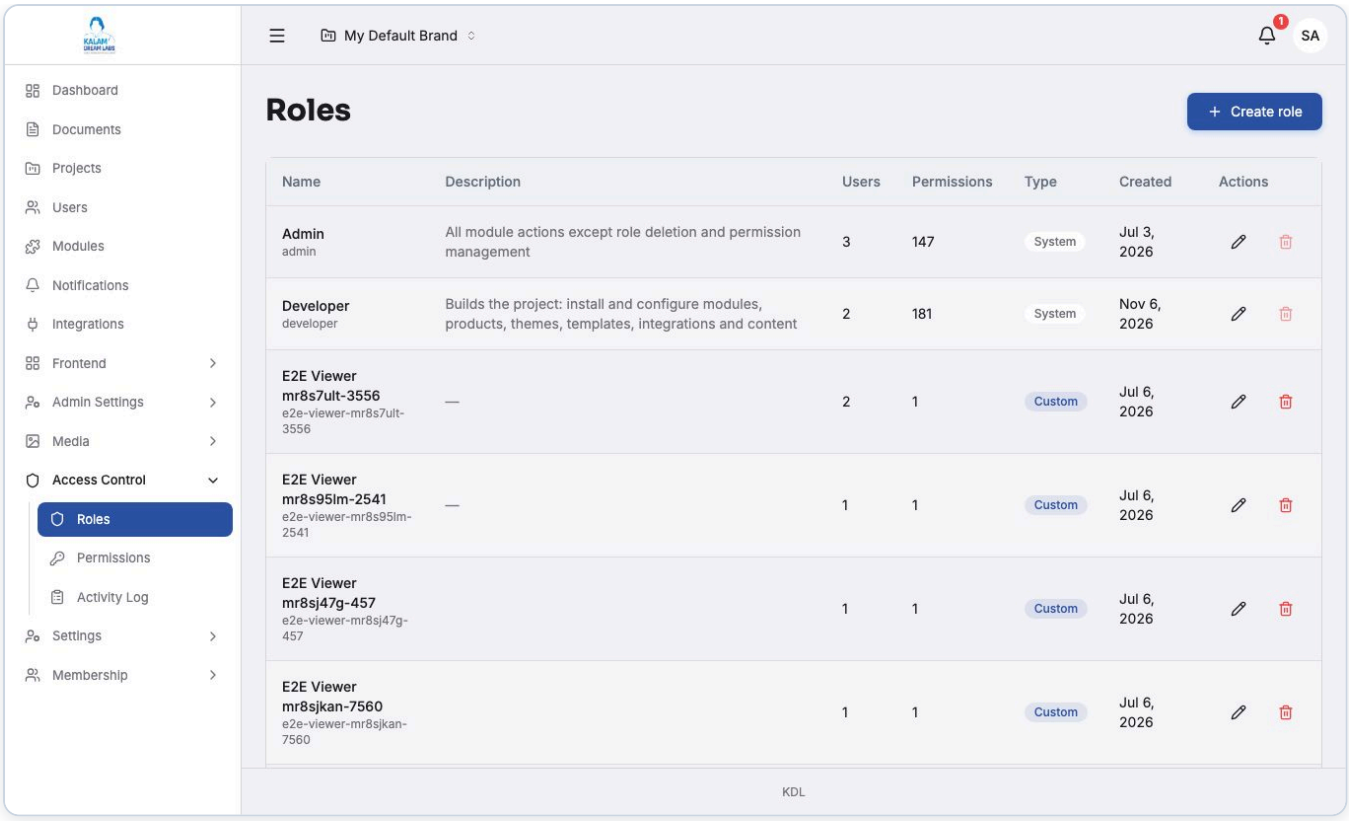
Admin Settings > Themes

Run the admin

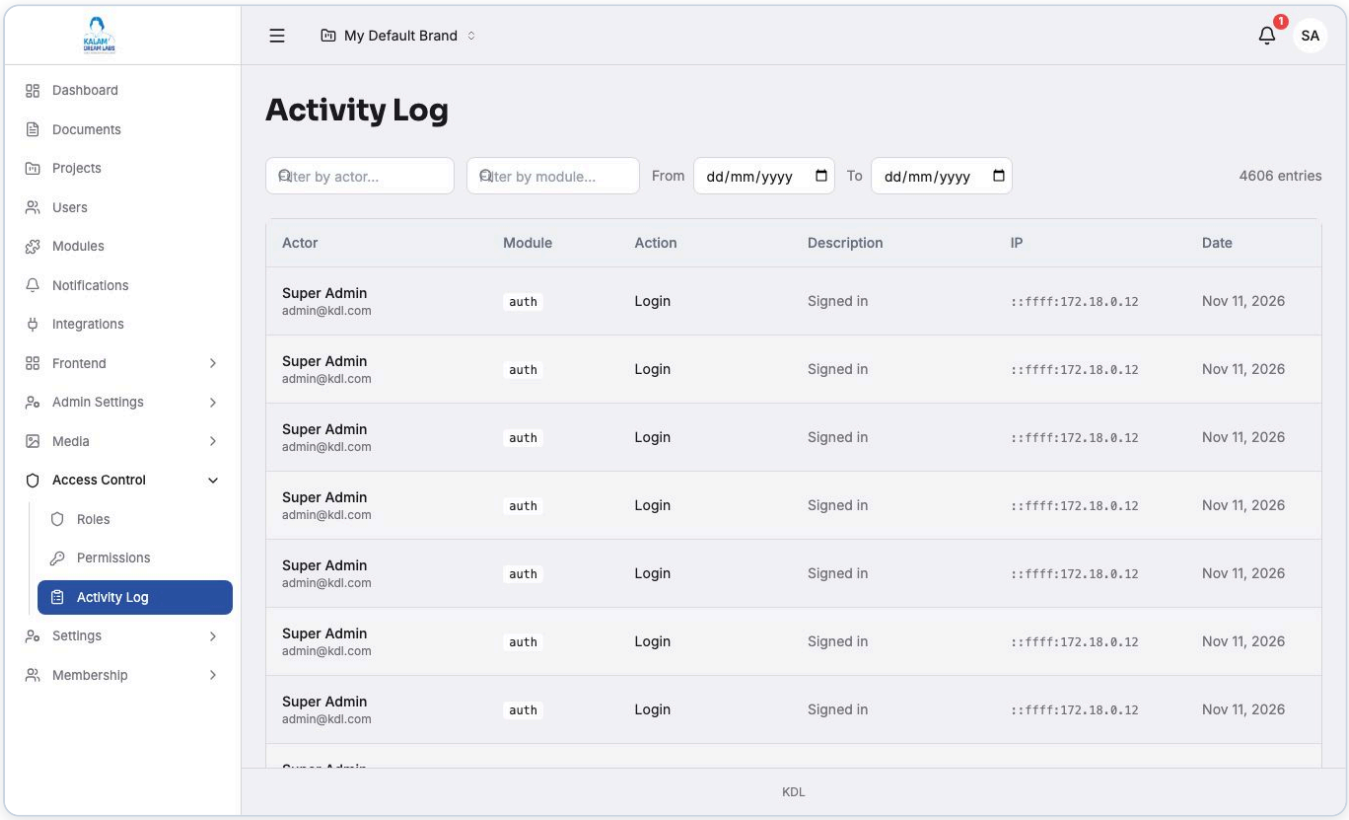
Need	Screen
Add and suspend people	**Users**
Decide who can do what	**Access Control > Roles / Permissions** (Super Admin, Developer, Admin, User)
See who did what	**Access Control > Activity Log**
Alerts	**Notifications** (bell, top right)
Connect outside tools	**Integrations**
Files and images	**Media > Library**; storage under **Settings > Storage**



Users



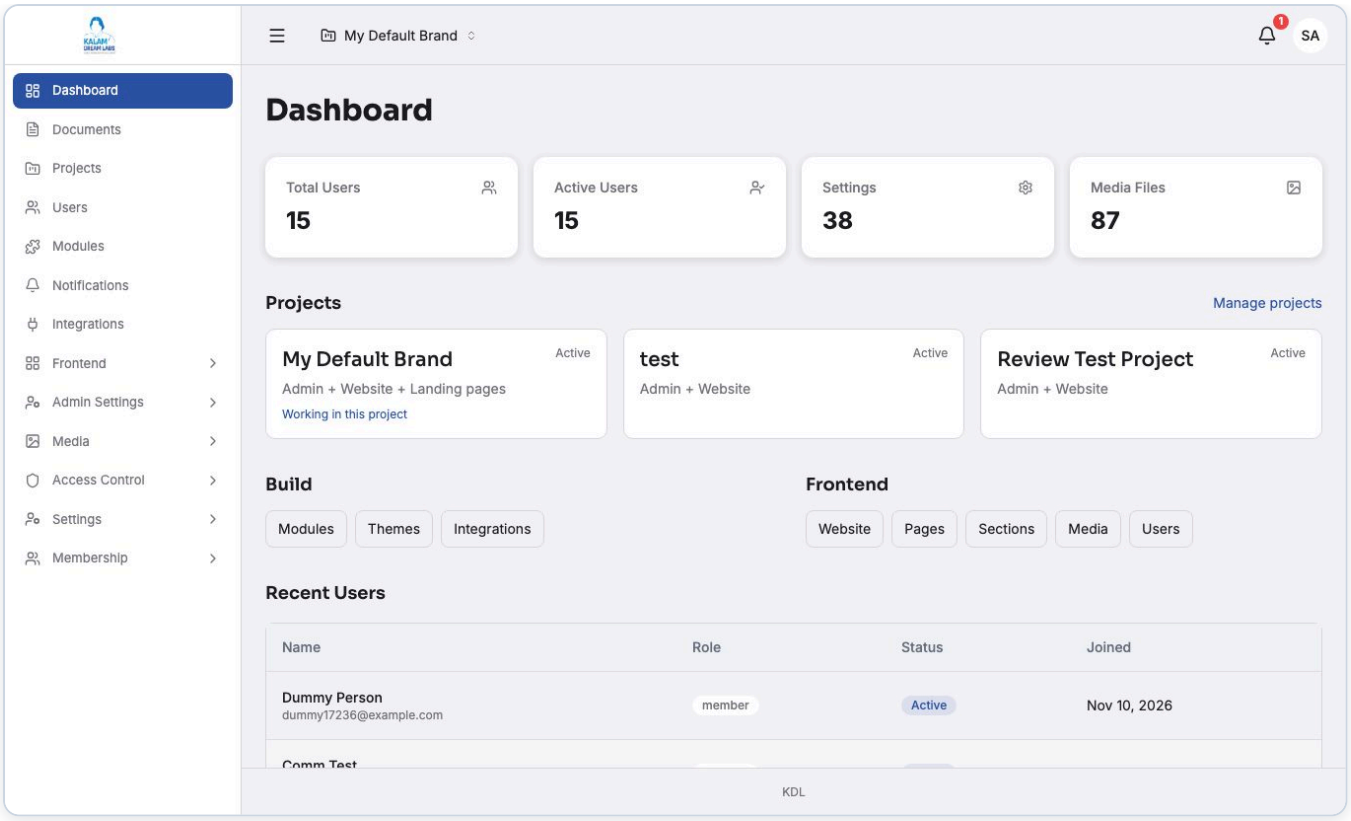
Access Control > Roles



Activity Log

Your dashboard

Public-site menu entries stay hidden because no public product is selected.



Dashboard

Check it worked

- Open the public address in a private window, signed out.
- Top bar, header and footer match Home on every page.
- Every menu link opens a page; forms send (web app) or show your contact details (static).
- The admin sidebar shows only the modules your flow needs.
- `docker compose ps` shows every service up and `backend` healthy.

Everyday commands

Run inside the `kdl-os` folder.

I want to	Type
Stop (keeps data)	`docker compose down`
Start again	`docker compose up -d`
See what runs	`docker compose ps`
Update to the latest code	`git pull` then `docker compose up -d --build`
Read backend logs	`docker compose logs backend --tail 100`

> `docker compose down -v` deletes **all your data**. Do not use it unless you want to start from zero.

If something goes wrong

Problem	Do this
A variable is missing	Wrong folder, or A3 was skipped. Go to `kdl-os` and repeat A3.
Port already in use	Close the program using it (for example a local site on port 80).
Build stops with Killed or out of memory	Give Docker 8 GB (A1), run A4 again.
502 Bad Gateway	Still starting. Wait 1 to 2 minutes and refresh.
Wrong password	Did you run A5? First password is `kdl-dev-seed-password`.
Account locked / 429	Wait a minute, or `docker compose restart backend`.